

DM INSTRUCTIONS

Items that do not duplicate a spell effect are assigned time and cost requirements by the DM. For example:

<u>Item:</u>	<u>Cost:</u>	<u>Time:</u>
20 arrows + 1	10,000 gp	1 month
plate mail + 1	10,000 gp	6 months
crystal ball	30,000 gp	6 months
ring of x-ray vision	100,000 gp	1 year
ring of spell storing	10,000 gp	1 month/spell level

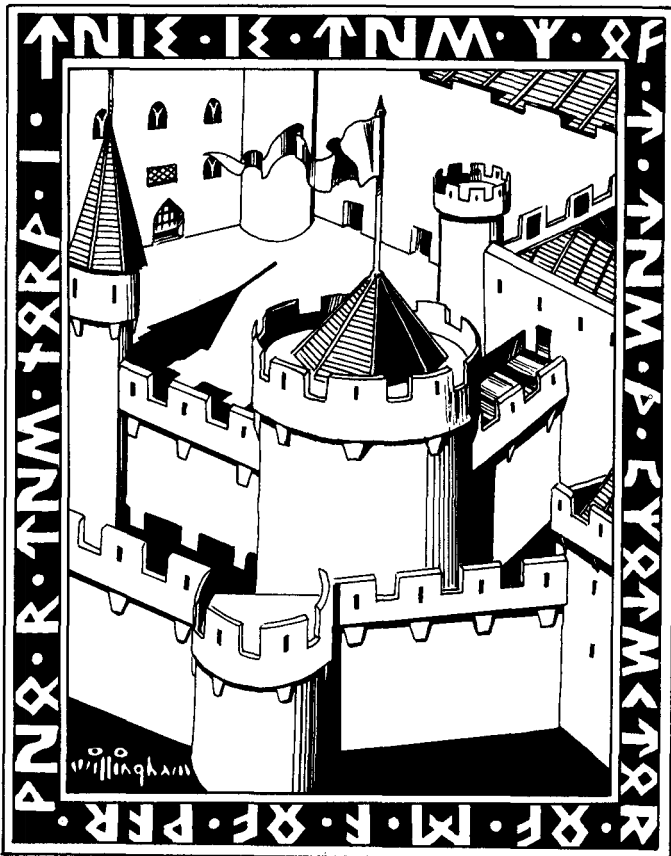
To limit the production of some of the more powerful items, the DM may require rare substances for production. These will be very costly, hard to find, time consuming, or require a special adventure to get.

A spell caster may want to use magic in a way not covered by spells or production: cleansing a defiled temple, opening a gate to another world, setting magical traps, and so on. The DM may let the spell caster research the steps necessary to do this by assigning time and cost requirements as for magic item production. The rituals may require rare substances or the casting of certain spells, and may have to be renewed periodically.

CASTLES, STRONGHOLDS, AND HIDEOUTS

When building a castle or stronghold, a character must first clear a hex or local area of monsters, entering the hex with a force of men and dealing with any lairs the DM has set up in the area. (The DM may also require the character get a land grant from the local ruler, if any.) The player should draw complete plans of the stronghold, using the guidelines given. After the DM approves the plans, an *engineer* should be hired, and the construction begins.

When the building is complete, the character may want to clear the surrounding area of monsters. The cleared area will remain free of

**D&D: EXPERT**

monsters as long as it is patrolled. Patrols usually range up to 18 miles from a castle or stronghold, though jungles, swamps, and mountains will require a garrison every 6 miles to keep the area clear.

Settlers can be attracted to cleared areas by spending money on improvements (inns, mills, boatyards, etc.) or advertising. The costs and the number of settlers who move into the area are up to the DM. The settlers will pay **taxes** (10 gp per year or whatever the DM decides) to help maintain the holding and the character's mercenaries.

Castle Plans. When drawing castle plans, the player should allow for wall thickness. Castle walls are about 10' thick, tower and gate-house walls are about 5' thick, and house stone walls are about 1-2' thick. Typical structures include:

Castle Wall, 100' long, 20' high	5,000 gp
Bastion, 30' base, 30' high	9,000 gp
Round Tower, 20' base, 30' high	15,000 gp
Round Tower, 30' base, 40' high	30,000 gp
Square Keep, 60' base, 80' high	75,000 gp
Moat, 100' long, 20' wide, 10' deep	400 gp
Gatehouse, 30' x 20' base, 20' high, with portcullis	6,500 gp
Barbican, two 20' x 30' towers, gatehouse, and drawbridge	37,000 gp
Dungeon Corridor, 10' x 10' x 10', stone flagged	500 gp
Stone Building, Civilian (two story, attic, 120' of wall, wooden doors, stairs, floors, and roof)	3,000 gp
Wooden Building (as above)	1,500 gp

Construction Time. The time required for construction is one game day for every 500 gp spent. This assumes the land has already been cleared and prepared and all the materials are on hand. For every 100,000 gp a construction costs, one engineer must be hired.

Walls. Cost is normal to 30' height, but double cost from 30' to 60' height (the maximum).

Towers. Cost is normal until height equals base width; building higher costs twice the normal amount. Towers may be no more than twice as high as their base width.

Other Costs

Stairs	(3' x 10')		Roof/Floor(10' x 10')	
	wood	20	wood	40
	stone	60**	flagstone/tile	100**
Door (3' x 7')	wood	10	Arrow Slit or Window	10**
	reinforced	20**	Shutters (window)	5**
	iron/stone	50	Bars (window)	10**
	secret	cost x5	Shifting Wall (10' x 10')	1000
Trap Door (4' x 3')		cost x2		

****These, plus internal walls and modest furnishings, can be assumed by adding 25% to the cost of the basic structure.**

Other constructions, such as a home, tavern or barn, of stone cost about 40% of the given costs. Wooden constructions cost about 20% of the given costs.

The DM may round construction costs up to the nearest convenient figure to make record-keeping simple.